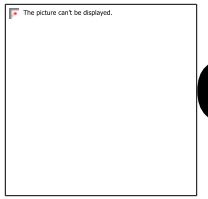
ENGLISH I, ENG 1011, CLASS 2

Reading Strategies & Reading Comprehension

- Skimming
- Scanning
- Inferencing



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Objectives:

1. Differentiate between Skimming, Scanning & Inferencing.
2. Master the Logic of True/False/Not Given (T/F/NG).
3. Tackle MCQs and Q&A without getting confused.

SKIMMING –MAIN IDEA

- Focus:
- To get a bird's eye view
- Fast reading to get the general idea/Overview
- Running eyes along the page; you choose what to read.



Techniques: reading the

(1) Title
(2) Introduction
(3) Conclusion
(4) Headings and
(5) The first and last sentences of paragraphs.

SCANNING–SPECIFIC INFORMATION

- Focus:
- Reading rapidly in order to find specific details, such as names,numbers,dates etc.



- Techniques for Scanning include:

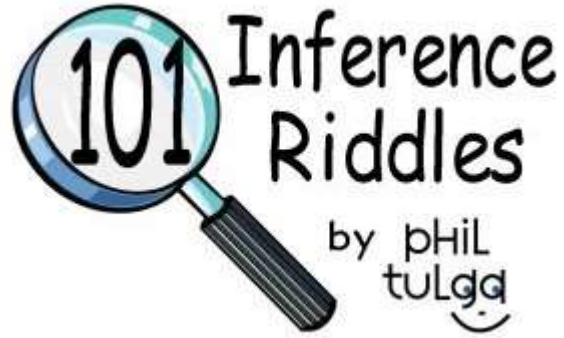
(1) Read the question and search for key words or ideas associated with the question

(2) Quickly moving eyes over the text

(3) Less reading and more searching –the brain hunts for specific information

INFERENCING= TEXT+ PRIOR KNOWLEDGE

- Process of drawing logical conclusion
- By using clues from the text together with own prior knowledge
- Reading “between the lines" to understand the writer's intended meaning.



Formula:
Text Clues + Background Knowledge = Inference

Practice 1 – Skimming:

Text:
The Amazon rainforest is often called the lungs of the Earth. It produces about 20% of the world’s oxygen and is home to millions of species. Deforestation, however, threatens this ecosystem, leading to loss of biodiversity and contributing to climate change.

- Task: Skim in 10 seconds. Write the main idea in ONE sentence.

Practice 2 – Scanning:

Text:

University Notice
Department of CSE, UIU
English Club Orientation Programme
Date: 15 September 2026
Time: 10:30 a.m.–12:00 p.m.
Venue: Seminar Room 302
Guest Speaker: Prof. Nusrat Jahan
Registration Deadline: 12 September

Questions

When is the orientation programme?
Where will the programme take place?
Who is the guest speaker?
What is the registration deadline?



Practice 3–Inferencing:

Text:
Rahim entered the classroom with wet clothes and an umbrella.
He was shivering and looking for some dry clothes.

Question:
What can you infer?

MCQ – The "Keyword" Strategy :

1. Read the Question first (not the options yet).
2. Focus on Keywords (Names, Years, Specialized terms).
3. Go back to the passage and locate that keyword.
4. Read the surrounding 2-3 sentences carefully.
5. Don't just match a keyword in an option to the text.

Understand the meaning of the whole sentence.

6. Cross out options that are clearly wrong.



Mastering True / False / Not Given (T/F/NG) :

1. TRUE: The information is in the passage and agrees with the writer.
2. FALSE: The information contradicts the passage (The passage says the opposite).
3. NOT GIVEN: The information is simply not there, or the writer doesn't mention it.



Tips:

- It’s all about the writer’s opinion, not your own general knowledge!
- Match Meaning, Not Keywords.
- Quantity: All vs. Some vs. Majority.
- Frequency: Always vs. Often vs. Occasionally.
- Order of Answers: T/F/NG answers almost always appear in order in the text.

Question & Answers:



1. Look for Definitions: Often, the text will define a term. The question will ask for that term.
2. Transition Words: Pay attention to However, In contrast, Moreover—these usually lead to the answer.
3. Don’t read the whole passage: You don't have time! Go question-by-question.
4. Context Clues: Guess difficult words by looking at the words around them.

PRACTICE FROM WORKSHEET

Based on Skimming, Scanning and Inferencing, we will practice

- **M C Q**
- **Short Answer Questions**
- **True & False**



Reading Comprehension:

The Battle of Palashi and the Sepoy Mutiny

British East India Company ruled the Indian subcontinent for more than 200 years and then the continent was colonized by the British Empire. The natives who raised their voice against the British East India Company fought two battles. The first one is the Battle of Palashi which took place at Palashi on the banks of the Hooghly river on 23rd June, 1757. It was about 150 kilometers north of Calcutta and south of Murshidabad, then the capital of Bengal. It was an eight-hour battle in which Nawab Sirajuddaula was defeated by the British East India Company authority. Mir Jafar, the leading General of Nawab's army, took a bribe from Lord Clive and worked for them. On the contrary, Mir Madan and Diwan Mohanlal, Generals of the Nawab's army were faithful and loyal to Nawab Sirajuddaula. Lord Clive promised Mir Jafar that he would make Jafar Nawab of Bengal. Because of Jafar's treachery, the British got the control over the people. The battle laid the foundation of the British rule in India. Some opine that Bengal was the springboard from which the British expanded their territorial domain and subsequently built up the empire which gradually engulfed most parts of India and ultimately many parts of Asia as well. A hundred years after the Palashi war, the Indian people laid out another noteworthy attempt in 1857 to get rid of the British oppression, which is called the Sepoy Mutiny of 1857. Some historians and experts term it as 'India's first war of independence'. It was a major uprising in India during 1857-58 against the rule of the British East India Company which began at Barrackpur under the leadership of Mangal Pandey on 29 March 1857.

P.T.O

It, then, in no time spread to Meerut, Delhi and many other parts of India. Bangladesh also felt the vibe of the revolt. The confrontations in Chittagong and Dhaka and clashes at Sylhet, Jessore, Rangpur, Pabna and Dinajpur had left Bangladesh in a state of alert and excitement. On 18 November 1857, the native infantry of Chittagong rose in open rebellion and released all prisoners from the jail. After that, they seized arms and ammunition, ransacked the treasury, and set the Magazine House on fire. In the skirmish that followed several sepoys were killed and arrested while many of them fled towards Mymensingh. Most of the fugitives were, however, arrested and put up for summary trial by a hurriedly constituted Court Martial. Of the accused sepoys, 11 were sentenced to death and the rest were sentenced to life imprisonment. The role and reaction of various classes of people of Bangladesh during the sepoy revolt present a gloomy picture. The landed aristocracy was decidedly opposed to the sepoys, and some of them rendered logistic support to the Company authorities by supplying carts, carriages and elephants, reporting the movements of the fleeing sepoys and finally organizing local volunteer corps to resist the sepoys. Both the rebellions provide us with some messages. One is that the people of this region-the people of Bangladesh- always had a desire for freedom. Another is that it is always tough to win your desired freedom if you have internal enemies like Mir Jafar. So, we must be conscious of both the internal and external enemies who are trying to stop us from becoming a developed country.



Part 1: MCQs

1. According to the text, why was Bengal considered a "springboard" for the British?
   A. Because of its strategic location on the Hooghly river.
   B. It provided the base from which they expanded their empire across India and Asia.
   C. It was the only region where they faced no internal enemies.
   D. It was the capital of the British Empire at the time of the battle.

2. What was the specific role of the "landed aristocracy" during the 1857revolt?
   A. They led the rebellion alongside Mangal Pandey.
   B. They remained neutral and refused to participate in the conflict.
   C. They actively supported the British with logistics and intelligence.
   D. They released prisoners and burned the Magazine House.



3. Which of the following is TRUE regarding the timeline of these events?
   A. The Sepoy Mutiny started exactly fifty years after the Battle of Palashi.
   B. Sirajuddaula was defeated on the same day the Mutiny began in Barrackpur.
   C. The Mutiny began in 1857, exactly one century after the Battle of Palashi.
   D. The British Empire took control immediately after the Battle of Palashi.

4. The phrase "gloomy picture" refers to:
   A. The dark weather during the battles.
   B. The disappointing lack of unity among the local people against the British.
   C. The heavy casualties suffered by the British East India Company.
   D. The physical destruction of Chittagong and Dhaka.

5. What is the primary "internal" obstacle to freedom mentioned in the conclusion?
   A. Lack of modern weapons and ammunition.
   B. Geographical distance between major cities like Calcutta and Murshidabad.
   C. The presence of traitors who prioritize personal gain over national interest.
   D. The overwhelming military strength of the British Empire.



Part 2: True/False/Not Given

❑ Write T for True, F for false, and NG for Not Given.

a. Lord Clive was not assisted by Mir Madan because he was loyal to Mir Jafar. ___

b. The British East India Company is informally called John Company. __

c. The Native Infantry of Chittagong not only seized arms and ammunition but also made some prisoners free. __

d. The battle of Palashi and the Sepoy mutiny did not bring any positive psychological change in people. __

e. The British cheated Mir Jafar after they had become victorious over Nawab Sirajuddaula. __

f. Some poor people supported the British in resisting the sepoys from succeeding. ___

Part 3: Questions & Answers

❑ Answer the following questions.

a. Why could not Nawab Sirajuddaula win over the British?

b. Who, do you think, are the internal and external enemies for Bangladeshi people?

c. How long were we ruled by the British East India Company?

d. Where did the Sepoy Mutiny begin?

e. What happened to the sepoys who tried to flee?

f. What was the role of the landed aristocracy during the Sepoy Mutiny?



THANK YOU

ANY QUESTIONS?

